

iCamp

Reframing campsite discovery
from “finding options” to
“trusting them enough to book.”



CONTEXT

Self-initiated
portfolio project

DURATION

3 weeks

ROLE

Solo design

STATUS

Validated
Not shipped

THE THESIS

**Campers don't struggle
to find places to camp.**

**They struggle to trust
them enough to commit.**

*A self-initiated product design exploration
about how structured information —
not more options — drives confident
decisions in trip planning.*

Camping is growing as a way to disconnect.
Planning a trip is still fragmented and manual.

The problem isn't finding options. It's trusting them enough to commit.

Picking the wrong campsite with a young family isn't a minor inconvenience — it's a ruined trip.
This reframed the brief from “improve search” to “support confident decisions.”

Mixed methods + the user with the highest stakes.

EVIDENCE

Survey (n=140) + 5 in-depth interviews.

51% Report difficulty finding new campsites

45% Rely on Facebook for discovery

#1 Lack of reliable info — most cited frustration

THE INSIGHT THAT BECAME THE BRIEF

Search → validate → hesitate → search.

Users get stuck in the loop instead of moving forward.

Primary User — Decision Context



Richard, 39

Family-oriented camper

Camps with his wife and young daughter and values safe, well-planned trips.

Context

- Lives in São Paulo and uses camping as a way to disconnect from routine and spend time in nature.
- Because he usually travels with family, choosing a campsite is less about spontaneity and more about trust, structure, and predictability.

Behaviors

- Discovers campsites through Facebook, Google, and camping communities
- Cross-checks multiple sources before deciding
- Plans around route, infrastructure, and nearby services

Friction Points

- Information is scattered and inconsistent
- Important details are often missing
- Contacting campsite owners is slow or unreliable

Core Need

🍏 I need to be sure this place is safe and suitable for my family before I commit.

Success Looks Like

Being able to quickly evaluate a campsite, trust the information, and complete the booking without uncertainty.

Richard represents a broader behavior pattern; people are willing to **explore**, but they **need enough reliable information** to feel confident before booking.

Richard represents a broader behavior pattern; people are not just looking for new places but may need enough **reliable information** to feel confident before booking.

Designed for Richard — family camper.
Demanding criteria pull the bar up for everyone.

**Campers want the planning
bureaucracy in the app,
so the camping itself
doesn't have to.**

Discovered in usability testing. Reframed the product positioning.

Competing apps act as a portal to the trip. iCamp absorbs the friction the trip is meant to escape.

Compete on decision quality. Sacrifice community for structure.

PRIORITIZED

Structured, standardized information.

As the trust mechanism. Same attribute structure on every listing makes comparison fast.

DEPRIORITIZED

Community and social features.

Profiles, follows, UGC threads. I lose network effects — but they don't solve first-use trust.

WHY

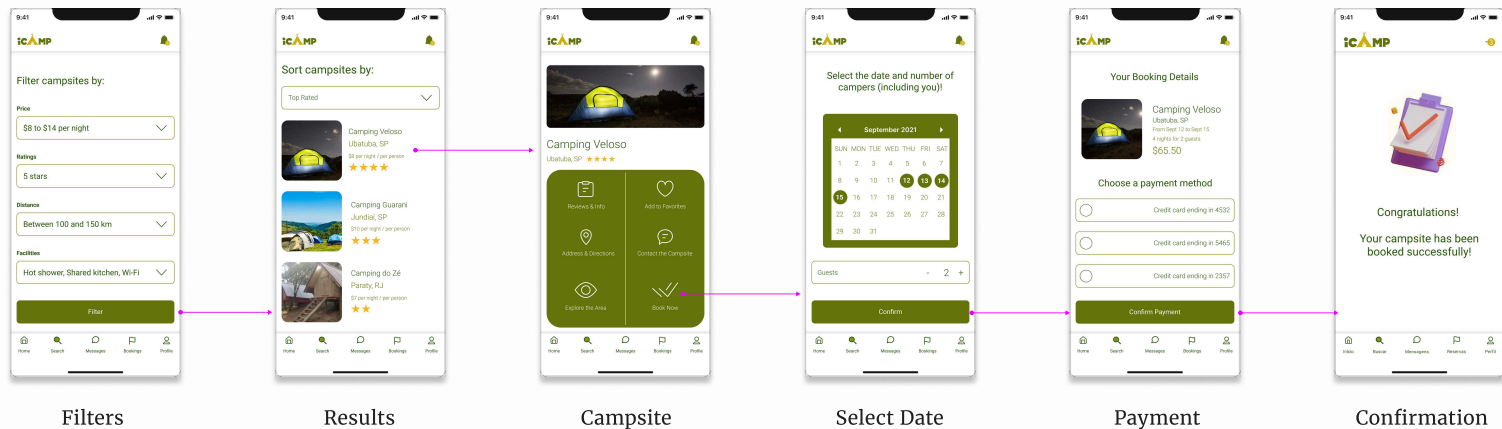
First-use trust over engagement loops.

Camping is low-frequency, high-stakes. Community works for Strava. Structure works for Booking.

This is a real trade-off. I'd revisit community after structured info proved itself on its own.

Search → Campsite → Booking, in one flow.

Profiles lead with what campers actually decide on: photos, structured details, and reviews as decision-relevant signals.



What I got wrong on the first pass.

WHAT I DESIGNED FIRST

~15 Filter
dimensions

Every filter users mentioned. The theory:
more control equals better decisions.

WHAT I IMPROVED AFTER TESTING

4 primary filters,
rest progressive

Participants used three or four. The rest
created cognitive load before they'd seen
a campsite.

THE TAKEAWAY

Completeness is a designer's instinct — not a user need.

How I'd measure success and what I'd revisit.

HOW I'D MEASURE THIS

PRIMARY

Time-to-decision

Median time from first search to booking.

SECONDARY

Cross-platform validation rate

Users leaving the app to verify info.

COUNTER

Booking regret rate

Structured info shouldn't cause expectation mismatch.

WHAT THIS TAUGHT ME

Cutting filters taught me that completeness often serves a designer's sense of rigor, not the user's decision.

WHAT I'D REVISIT

- Wider sample, including less tech-fluent users.
- Pressure-test the no-community decision.
- Prototype next to the owner of the experience.

EXPLORE THE PROTOTYPE

[Figma prototype link](#)

Thanks for reading.